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17 Remove the tailstock to give you access to the foot area. Recess the foot area to give you a rim for the box to stand. Don't go too deep or you will go through the base. Once you have finished with the gouge use the scraper if needed

18 Use the long point of the skew chisel to add a little detail on the inside of the foot. This shows you care about the underside as much as the top. Sand through all the grades of abrasives; keep stopping the lathe to check all the marks have been removed, then seal the surface

19 I have prepared the finial as in panel 3. Use tailstock support at first to turn up and start the shaping on the end of the finial. You can use a piece of white card behind the work to show the profile more. Take small cuts with the spindle gouge; remember that the end 3mm will be removed to remove the hole from the revolving centre

20 Remove the tailstock to finish the end of the finial. Once the end is completed move to the stem, take this down in stages using small cuts as this will help stop vibrations when turning small diameters that are long. Don't go back to the very end or the finial may break

21 Once you have completed the stem you can now turn the bead at the end that will fit against the lid. Make sure you have bevel contact with the spindle gouge; you don't want to make a mistake now. Sand this to a fine finish – you may need to go up to 1,200 grade abrasive to give you a good surface – then seal the finial

22 Turn the spigot to match the hole in the top of the lid, use callipers to check this measurement. Now part the finial from the waste in the chuck. I use a three-part mop system to polish all the parts prior to gluing the finial in the top of the lid

23 The finished box should look something like this ●

HANDY HINTS

5. Exotic timbers are fine grained so will show scratches more than an open grain timber. This means you will need to sand to a higher grade abrasive
6. Don't skip abrasive grades, go through each one. It will be quicker and will give you a better finish

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